



Going out for a run is a great way to burn calories and a chance to get out in the fresh air. You can run off a juicy 150 calories with just 15 minutes' running.

is the amount of energy your body needs to function at rest, but we all burn/use calories at different rates. Your BMR is influenced by your age, sex, lean-muscle-to-fat ratio (a lean, muscular person will burn more calories than someone with a higher proportion of fat, even while sleeping), and your genetic package. The table opposite shows you how to calculate your daily calorie requirement. If you eat more than this, and don't move more, then you are simply going to get fat!

Let's say you want to lose 7lb (3.5kg). To get rid of just 1lb (0.5kg) of excess fat you must burn off around 3500 calories. Of course, you can pare down what you eat (and eating little and often also helps burn calories) but if you go for a two-pronged attack—diet *and* exercise—you have a much better chance of success. It's simple. Take in less fuel, burn more off. In addition, exercise will help build muscle which, in turn, will burn more fat.

So, what kind of exercise helps to burn the calories? Any exercise is better than none, but it's generally accepted that the best is aerobic exercise. This means working your cardiovascular system—the heart and lungs—by doing continuous, rhythmic exercise using large muscle

HOW MANY CALORIES CAN I BURN?

Whether you're exercising or simply doing household chores, you're always burning calories. This chart shows you how many, on average, a person weighing 155lb (70kg) burns doing each activity for 15 minutes. The calories burned vary according to your age, weight, level of fitness, and how hard you exercise.

DO THIS FOR 15 MINUTES	KCALS BURNED
Jumping rope	185
Boxing with a partner	165
Running (5mph/8kph)	150
Cross-country skiing	149
Cycling (12.5mph/20kph)	149
High-impact aerobics	130
Downhill skiing	111
Swimming	110
Shovelling snow	110
Low-impact aerobics	100
Dancing	100
Gardening	83
Childcare	65
Raking the lawn	60
Cooking	46
Sitting in a meeting	30
Working at the computer	26
Watching TV	14
Sleeping	11

groups. All the sequences in this book are aerobic, so following them is the best place to start, but the chart above shows how many calories you can burn doing different forms of exercise.

As well as knowing how many calories I burn when I exercise, I also like to have an idea of the caloric value of the foods I eat. Eating a chocolate chip cookie means I need to do 15 minutes of low-impact aerobics to compensate. Hmmm ...